



Experience, versatility and firepower: Jasprit Bumrah, Hardik Pandya and Suryakumar Yadav headline India's bid to retain the T20 crown. AFP

Order and ambush

With India and Pakistan **expected to cruise through**, Group A's drama rests less on rivalry and more on whether an outsider can disrupt a settled hierarchy.

Anish Pathiyil
anish.p@thehindu.co.in

T20 World Cup cricket has undergone a profound transformation since its early years, but one fixture remains constant: India versus Pakistan. The two rivals have been drawn into the same group for the sixth consecutive edition of the global event. They will

meet at the R. Premadasa Stadium in Colombo on February 15 in a match that will draw global attention. **The sides most recently clashed not once, not twice, but thrice in the Asia Cup 2025, including the final, where India triumphed by five wickets.** Both nations are expected to reach the Super Eight stage.

Defending champion India is the bookmaker's favourite to retain the crown, thanks to its experienced and highly skilled squad combined with its ability to calibrate risk and reward across phases of the innings. The Suryakumar Yadav-led side has a 75.6 win percentage, the highest among all teams at the World Cup,